CalWORKs Housing Support Program (HSP)	Number	Page
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Revision Date:
October 1, 2025

Background:
The CalWORKs Housing Support Program (HSP) provides assistance to CalWORKs families experiencing barriers to self-sufficiency due to homelessness or housing instability. HSP is not an entitlement program and will remain as funding and slots are available.

Purpose:
The purpose of this section is to provide eligibility requirements of HSP. This material revision is to add language regarding the required individualized housing plan, to update HSP services information and update the Homeless Programs Payment Grid (Attachment A).

Policy:
Eligibility Criteria
Eligible CalWORKs families must meet the following HSP requirements:

- Have an active CalWORKs case.
- Be considered homeless, as defined in 24 Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) Section 91.5 under *Homeless*:
  (1) An individual or family who lacks a fixed, regular, and adequate nighttime residence, meaning:
    i. An individual or family with a primary night-time residence that is a public or private place not designed for or ordinarily used as a regular sleeping accommodation for human beings, including a car, park, abandoned building, bus or train station, airport, or camping ground.
    ii. An individual or family living in a supervised publicly or privately-operated shelter designated to provide temporary living arrangements (including congregate shelters, transitional housing, and hotels and motels paid for by charitable organizations or by federal, state, or local government programs for low-income individuals).
    iii. An individual who is exiting an institution where they resided for 90 days or less and who resided in an emergency shelter or place not meant for human habitation immediately before entering that institution.
  (2) An individual or family who will imminently lose their primary nighttime residence, provided that:
    i. The primary night-time residence will be lost within 14 days of the date of application for homeless assistance,
    ii. No subsequent residence has been identified, and
    iii. The individual or family lacks the resources or support networks such as family, friends, faith-based or other social networks needed to obtain other permanent housing.
  (3) Unaccompanied youth under 25 years of age, or families with children and youth, who do not otherwise qualify as homeless under this definition, but who:
    i. Are defined as homeless under section 387 of the Runaway and Homeless Youth Act (42 U.S.C. 5732a), section 637 of the Head Start Act (42 U.S.C. 9832), section 41403 of the Violence Against Women Act of 1994 (42 U.S.C. 14043e-2), section 330(h) of the Public Health Service Act (42 U.S.C. 254b(h)), section 3 of the Food and Nutrition Act of 2008 (7 U.S.C. 2012), section 17(b) of the Child Nutrition Act of 1966 (42 U.S.C. 1786(b)), or section 725 of the McKinney-Vento Homeless Assistance Act (42 U.S.C. 11434a),

ii. Have not had a lease, ownership interest, or occupancy agreement in permanent housing at any time during the 60 days immediately preceding the date of application for homeless assistance,
iii. Have experienced persistent instability as measured by two moves or more during the 60-day period immediately preceding the date of applying for homeless assistance, and
iv. Can be expected to continue in such status for an extended period of time because of chronic disabilities, chronic physical health or mental health conditions, substance addiction, histories of domestic violence or childhood abuse (including neglect), the presence of a child or youth with a disability, or two or more barriers to employment, which include the lack of a high school degree or General Education Development (GED), illiteracy, low English proficiency, a history of incarceration or detention for criminal activity, and a history of unstable employment, or

(4) Any individual or family who:
i. Is fleeing, or is attempting to flee, domestic violence, dating violence, sexual assault, stalking, or other dangerous or life-threatening conditions that relate to violence against the individual or a family member, including a child, that has either taken place within the individual's or family's primary nighttime residence or has made the individual or family afraid to return to their primary nighttime residence,
ii. Has no other residence, and
iii. Lacks the resources or support networks, such as family, friends, faith-based or other social networks, to obtain other permanent housing.

Prioritization

HSP services will be prioritized for families who lack a fixed, regular, and adequate nighttime residence followed by those who will imminently lose their primary nighttime residence.

HSP Service Examples

The following services will be provided under HSP:

- Intensive Case Management:
  - Assessment of housing barriers.
  - Development of a housing plan.
  - Financial literacy/coaching.
  - Help resolving legal issues.
  - Referrals to resources as needed.

- Housing Navigation:
  - Landlord recruitment and retention.
  - Help finding and securing permanent housing for customers.

- Financial Assistance:
  - Bridge housing.
  - Relocation costs.
  - Move-in costs (such as deposits, moving expenses, utilities).
  - Rental subsidy.
  - Eviction prevention services to avoid a pending eviction.

HSP is offered in addition to the following programs or services available to CalWORKs customers, if they are otherwise eligible:

- Temporary Homeless Assistance (THA)/Permanent Homeless Assistance (PHA).
  - When a housing need is identified, in addition to THA/PHA, customers must also be automatically referred to HSP staff for evaluation for HSP.
  - When appropriate, HSP staff will also refer the customer to apply for THA/PHA.
- Family Stabilization, Non-Housing Services, such as utility assistance and car repairs, if participating in Employment Services (ES).

Housing First Concept

Contractors will establish a Housing First concept for HSP. Housing First-oriented programs are low or no barrier and customer-centered, emphasizing customer-choice. Housing is viewed as necessary to help a family or individual stabilize and meaningfully access services, which are offered as needed on a voluntary basis.

In practice, this means that programs connect participants to permanent housing as quickly as possible with few to no preconditions, behavioral contingencies, or other barriers at enrollment or throughout the program. Instead of requiring people to stabilize before receiving housing, programs using a Housing First approach focus on helping people achieve housing stability before addressing other barriers that may exist.

To ensure effective implementation of Housing First, HSP staff will work collaboratively with the customers to develop individualized housing and services plans for all customers after their HSP enrollment, by utilizing form 27-392 HHSA – Housing Support Program Agreement and Assessment Plan.

Procedure:

Procedures for administering HSP services and the referral process can be found in the following:

- CalWORKs Processing Guide 10-008.A1, Housing Support Program Referral Process.
  - Family Resource Center staff will refer CalWORKs families meeting all eligibility requirements described above to the County's HSP providers.
- Attachment A, CalWORKs Desk Aid, Homeless Programs Payment Grid.

Impacts:

Forms

Form 27-392 HHSA, has been created to develop housing plans with HSP customers:

- This form provides an overview of the housing search process and outlines the expectations of both the customer and the housing specialist. This form must be used to develop individualized housing and services plans, by collecting information from customers regarding their past and current living situations to identify and address barriers to housing stability.
- The form is not available in CalSAWS. A manual PDF fill-in enabled form is available for immediate print from the Eligibility Forms Library (EFL). Shelf stock may be ordered from the Xerox Print Center.

References:

- Senate Bill (SB) 855, SB 1380.
- 24 CFRC Section 91.5, Homeless Sections (1)-(4).
- All County Welfare Directors Letters (ACWDL) July 18, 2014, May 13, 2021.
- All County Letters (ACL) No. 19-114, 24-88.

Sunset Date:

This policy will be reviewed for continuance by October 31, 2028.

Approval for Release:

10-16-25

Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services

Attachment A

CalWORKs and Employment Services (ES)
Homeless Assistance Programs Summary

Housing Support Program (HSP) Financial Assistance Guidelines (Enrolled in CalWORKs, Managed by ES Contractors)		
Maximum financial assistance available is $20,000 per family.		
	Financial Payment Type	**Limitations**
Eviction Prevention	• Past due rent • Late fees	Maximum of 2 months
Bridge Housing	• Hotel/Motel Voucher	Up to 90 days
Permanent Housing	• Rental Deposits • First/last month rent	As reasonable and within customer's ability to sustain
Rental Assistance	Monthly rental subsidy, based upon 30% - 100% of the family's current income: • If the family has no income, the rent is paid 100% with HSP funds • If the family has stable income, the family's rent share is anywhere from 30% to 100% of their current income, remainder is paid with HSP funds	Up to 6 months, based on need Customer's share to increase monthly
Other	• Housing application fees • Credit check fees • Relocation services	As needed
The HSP program follows the Rapid Rehousing/Housing First model in this priority: permanent housing, rental subsidy, temporary housing.		

Attachment A

CalWORKs and Employment Services (ES)
Homeless Assistance Programs Summary

ES Family Stabilization Financial Assistance Guidelines (Registered in ES. Managed by ES Contractors)		
Family Stabilization has a consecutive up to 12 months payment limit that is based on the size of the CalWORKs Assistance Unit (AU) and the type of services requested.		
Financial Payment Type		**12-Month Cumulative Limit**
Eviction Prevention	• Past due rent • Late fee	Maximum of two months
Bridge Housing	• Hotel/motel voucher • Storage Fees	Up to $150 per day, up to 90 days (as needed), including taxes and fees
Permanent Housing	• Rental Deposit • First and/or Last Month's Rent as required in the lease	AU size 1-4 Up to $3,500 AU size 5+ Up to $4,500

CalWORKs Homeless Assistance (Enrolled in CalWORKs. Managed by County Family Resource Centers)
Homeless Assistance is limited to once every 12 months
Temporary Homeless Assistance (Bridge Housing - hotel/motel): • $85 per day up to 16 days for an Assistance Unit size of 4 • Additional Assistance Unit members can get an additional $15 per day, maximum is **$145 per day
Permanent Homeless Assistance: Rental assistance benefit threshold is 80% of the family's Total Monthly Household Income